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Image Source: Deloitte

The Critical Infrastucture Bill: Why Should We Care

Written By : Chu Wai Lam @Alpacian

Last time, we have introduced to you the danger of scams utilising deepfake technology. We would like to remind our readers once again to be vigilant and verify the authenticity of any suspicious media.

Today, we will breifly talk about the Protection of Critical Infrastructures (Computer Systems) Ordinance (Cap. 653) and why we should care.

Monthly Cybersecurity Tips:

- Always lock your phone, tablet, and computer when not in use.
- Consider using a password manager to store all your passwords safely.
- Adjust privacy settings on social media to limit what the public can see online.

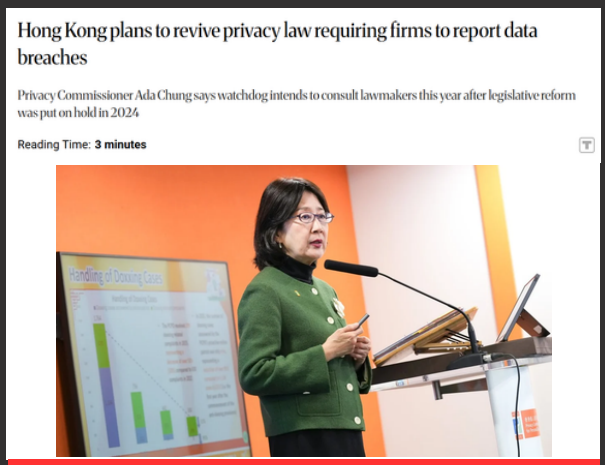
The Latest News in Cyber Security

The prevalence of cybersecurity incidents around the world is nothing to scoff at. This month, we have selected the following news articles that we deemed worthy of your attention. Stay informed, and stay protected.

AI-Powered Android Malware Identified

Cybersecurity researchers have recently uncovered what is believed to be the first Android malware that exploits Gemini, Google's generative AI chatbot, as part of its operational process. Gemini analyses the current screen and provides PromptSpy with detailed instructions to ensure that the malicious app remains pinned in the recent apps list, making it difficult to swipe away or terminate through the system.

The Hacker News



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New Development in Privacy Law

Early this month, Privacy Commissioner for Personal Data Ada Chung Lai-ling revealed that Hong Kong's privacy watchdog plans to revive legislative reforms requiring firms to report data breaches and face penalties. The reform was previously put on hold in 2024 due to concerns that stricter rules might harm the local business environment. It had been proposed that authorities could consider a "piecemeal approach" by first introducing minor improvements to minimise the impact on small businesses.

Microsoft Anti-Phishing Error

According to a preliminary post-incident report released this week by Microsoft, a software glitch in its email security system mistakenly identified thousands of legitimate URLs as phishing links for nearly a week. This error prevented users from accessing emails and Teams messages. The issue began on February 5 and was fully resolved by February 12. Throughout this period, users on Exchange Online and Microsoft Teams were unable to open links in messages, with some emails being completely quarantined.

Bleeping Computer

The Critical Infrastucture Bill: Why Should We Care

As cyberattacks continue to emerge, the essential services of cities and countries are prone to becoming targets. As such, HK has taken a proactive step and enacted the city's first dedicated cybersecurity law.

What is it about?

The Protection of Critical Infrastructures (Computer Systems) Ordinance (PCIO) focuses on protecting the computer systems of critical infrastructures (CIs) from cyber threats, ensuring their secure operation to prevent disruptions. In essence, CIs are defined as facilities and systems essential for maintaining Hong Kong's normal societal operations falling within the eight key sectors: energy, information technology, banking and financial services, air transport, land transport, maritime transport, healthcare services, and telecommunications and broadcasting. Additionally, it also covers critical societal or economic activities, such as major sports and performance venues or research and development parks.

Under the law, designated Critical Infrastructure Operators (CIOs) must comply with statutory obligations categorised into three areas: organisational measures (establishing security management plans), preventive actions (risk assessments and regular audits), and incident response and recovery (mandatory reporting of security incidents to the authorities).

Protection of Critical Infrastructures (Computer Systems) Ordinance

Image Source: Communication Authority

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HONG KONG ISSUES CODE OF PRACTICE UNDER THE PROTECTION OF CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURES (COMPUTER SYSTEMS) ORDINANCE

AUTHORS:
GABRIELA KENNEDY,
JOANNA K.C. WONG,
ROSLIE LIU

Mayer Brown

A Code of Practice, issued on the same day the ordinance took effect, provides detailed guidance to help CIOs meet these requirements, setting a baseline for compliance across sectors. Enforcement includes penalties at the organisational level for non-compliance, emphasising accountability without targeting individual employees.

Why is it established?

In our modern age, technology is so intricately woven into our everyday lives that it's safe to say it has become essential. As such, drawing inspiration from international standards and regulations in other regions, Hong Kong decided to make use of legislation to strengthen the city's overall cybersecurity resilience, reducing the risk of critical services being compromised.

Why should we care?

Although the ordinance mainly targets CIOs and their services, they serve as the backbone of society. By enforcing strong security measures, the law ensures that these essential services remain reliable and resilient, ultimately benefiting residents by lowering the chances of extensive disruptions due to cyberattacks. In a highly interconnected city like Hong Kong, this ordinance is not merely about corporate compliance; it is about safeguarding the stability and security that support daily life and long-term prosperity.